

Word family: **screw / screws / screwed / screwing / screwdriver**

Base word: screw

Plural: screws

Past tense: screwed

Past participle: screwed

-ing form: screwing

Useful related compound: screwdriver

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “My hands got covered in grease, some of the **screws** would not budge, and the whole process felt as slow as watching paint dry.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **screw** means a **small metal fastener with a spiral thread, usually turned with a screwdriver to hold pieces together**.

繁體中文： ** **表面有螺旋紋、透過旋轉擰入物料以固定零件的金屬緊固件；螺絲**

中文翻譯：

> “...some of the **screws** would not budge...”

「.....有些**螺絲**怎樣也扭不動.....」

Here:

screws = 用來固定單車零件的螺絲

1. **screw = threaded metal fastener (工具 / 零件) — 螺絲**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A metal fastener with a spiral ridge around it that is turned into material or a threaded hole to hold things together.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Some of the **screws** would not budge.”

「有些**螺絲**怎樣也扭不動。」

Practice 2

> “One of the **screws** in the chair had come loose.”

「椅子上的其中一顆**螺絲**鬆了。」

Practice 3

> “Remove the four **screws** from the back panel.”

「把後面板上的四顆**螺絲**拆下來。」

screw = 帶有螺旋紋、靠旋轉擰入以固定物件的緊固件

Common:

- * loose screw
- * tighten a screw
- * remove a screw
- * screw hole
- * screw head

2. **screw** = fasten something with screws (動詞) — 用螺絲固定；旋緊

As a verb, **screw** means to attach or secure something by turning a screw.

Practice 4

> “She **screwed** the shelf to the wall.”

「她用螺絲把架子**固定**在**牆**上。」

Practice 5

> “Make sure the cover is **screwed** firmly into place.”

「確保蓋子已經**旋緊固定**。」

screw something to/into something = 用螺絲透過旋轉把某物固定在另一物體上

This is the direct verb development from Meaning 1.

3. **screw = turn/twist something using a threaded mechanism (旋轉) — 旋 ; 擰 ; 扭**

Screw can also mean turning something that works through a spiral or threaded mechanism.

Practice 6

> “She **screwed** the lid tightly onto the jar.”

「她把瓶蓋**旋緊**在玻璃瓶上。」

Practice 7

> “He **screwed** the bulb into the socket.”

「他把燈泡**旋入**燈座。」

screw something into/on = 透過旋轉，把帶有螺紋的物件擰入或固定

This is very closely related to Meaning 2.

For strict database counting, I would merge #2 and #3 under the broader concept:

> **fasten or position something by twisting it along a thread**

The object changes—screw, lid, bulb—but the mechanical concept remains the same.

4. **screw = propeller, especially of a ship (機械) — 螺旋槳**

In engineering and nautical contexts, **screw** can mean a propeller whose rotating blades drive a ship through water.

Practice 8

> “The ship was driven by a large **screw**.”

「那艘船由一個大型**螺旋槳**推進。」

Practice 9

> “Damage to the **screw** reduced the vessel’s speed.”

「**螺旋槳**受損令船隻速度下降。」

****screw = 旋轉時產生推進力的螺旋槳，尤其用於船隻****

This is an established technical meaning, though lower-frequency for general learners.

5. ****screw = have sex with someone (粗俗 / 冒犯性) — 與某人性交****

As a verb, ****screw**** can be a vulgar informal term meaning to have sexual intercourse with someone.

Practice 10

> “The word ****screw**** can be used as a vulgar sexual verb.”

「****screw**** 這個詞可以粗俗地表示與某人性交。」

Practice 11

> “In this sense, it is inappropriate in polite or formal conversation.”

「在這個意思中，它不適合用於禮貌或正式場合。」

****screw someone = 與某人性交；粗俗、非正式，具有冒犯性****

This is genuinely distinct from the mechanical meanings and is common enough that learners should recognize it, even if they do not actively use it.

Related compound: ****screwdriver****

A ****screwdriver**** is a tool used for turning screws.

Practice 12

> “I need a ****screwdriver**** to remove this screw.”

「我需要一把****螺絲批 / 螺絲起子****來拆這顆螺絲。」

Practice 13

> “Use the correct ****screwdriver**** for the screw head.”

「要使用適合該螺絲頭的****螺絲批****。」

****screwdriver = 用來旋緊或拆除螺絲的工具****

This is a compound, not another meaning of bare ****screw****.

Important distinction: ****screw vs bolt****

These are easy to confuse.

****screw****

typically has a threaded shaft and is turned directly into material or a threaded hole.

****bolt****

usually passes through a hole and is often secured with a nut.

So:

****screw = 螺絲****

****bolt = 螺栓****

There is technical overlap in some designs, but this distinction is useful for general learners.

Important distinction: ****screw vs nail****

****screw****

is normally ****turned**** into material.

****nail****

is normally ****hammered**** into material.

> screw → screwdriver

> nail → hammer

So:

****screw = 螺絲****

****nail = 釘****

Important distinction: **screw vs twist**

twist

is the broad verb for turning something around.

screw

usually implies:

- * a threaded mechanism,
- * fastening,
- * or a screw-like rotational movement.

> “Twist the cap.”

broad.

> “Screw the cap on.”

specifically means turn it until it is secured.

Important distinction: **tighten a screw vs screw something in**

tighten a screw

= make an already inserted screw tighter

screw something in

= rotate it into its threaded position

In your passage, the screws:

> “would not budge”

probably means they could not be turned at all.

Phrasal-verb note

****Screw**** has several common phrasal or multiword expressions, such as:

- * screw up
- * screw around
- * screw someone over

Under your operating procedure, these should ****not**** be included in the core entry by default because phrasal verbs are normally excluded unless the target sentence requires them.

So I would keep them outside this entry.

Useful expression: ****have a screw loose — 有點瘋 / 古怪****

This is an idiom based on the mechanical noun.

Practice 14

> “People joked that he had a ****screw loose****.”

「大家開玩笑說他有點****古怪 / 腦子不太正常****。」

Practice 15

> “You must have a ****screw loose**** if you think that is a good idea.”

「你如果覺得那是好主意，真是有點****瘋了****。」

****have a screw loose = 行為或想法顯得古怪、不理性；非正式****

This is a fixed expression, not another core meaning.

Useful expression: ****put the screws on someone — 向某人施壓****

Practice 16

> “They began to ****put the screws on**** him to make a decision.”

「他們開始向他****施加壓力****，迫使他作決定。」

Practice 17

> “The manager put the ****screws on**** the team to finish sooner.”

「經理向團隊****施壓****，要求他們更快完成。」

****put the screws on someone = 對某人施加強大壓力，迫使其採取行動****

Again, this is idiomatic rather than a core bare-word meaning.

Countability note

The physical fastener ****screw**** is countable:

> a screw

> two screws

> several screws

This matches your passage:

> ****some of the screws****

The propeller meaning is also countable:

> a twin-screw ship

But when ****screw**** is used as a verb, countability does not apply.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****screw****

* ****screws****

* ****screwed****

* ****screwing****

Useful compound:

* ****screwdriver****

Useful constructions include:

* tighten a screw

- * loosen a screw
- * screw something to the wall
- * screw a lid on
- * screw a bulb in
- * have a screw loose

The Manual asks us to search broadly across inflections, compounds, fixed expressions, and specialist uses, but to filter low-value material and avoid treating every expression as a separate base-word sense.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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screw — fastener	帶有螺旋紋、靠旋轉擰入以固定物件的金屬緊固件；螺絲
screw — verb, fasten/turn	透過旋轉螺紋，把某物擰入、旋緊或固定
screw — propeller	利用旋轉產生推進力的螺旋槳，尤其用於船隻；較專門
screw — vulgar sexual verb	粗俗地表示與某人性交；非正式且具冒犯性
screwdriver	用來旋緊或拆除螺絲的工具
have a screw loose	比喻某人思想或行為古怪、不理性；非正式

For your original sentence

> “...some of the **screws** would not budge...”

The exact meaning is:

screw = 用來把單車零件固定在一起、表面帶有螺旋紋的金屬緊固件

So:

> **the screws would not budge**

= **那些螺絲完全扭不動 / 鬆不開**

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **screw**:

- noun — threaded metal fastener**
- verb — fasten/position something by turning it along a thread**
- noun — screw propeller**
- vulgar verb — have sex with someone**

I would merge **screw in / screw on / screw something to something** under #2, keep **screwdriver** as a compound, and keep expressions such as **have a screw loose** and the phrasal verbs outside the core count.